CULTURE · LANGUAGE · SOCIETY

Canada: A Mosaic, Not a Melting Pot

One country, many cultures?

Look at the Canadian flag. What do you know about Canada?

1. Is Canada a country of one culture or many?
2. What languages, traditions, or communities might you find there?

Start with what you already know.

A MODEL FOR SOCIETY

Mosaic or melting pot?

Melting pot

Different cultures blend into one shared culture.

Mosaic

Different cultures keep their identity while belonging to one society.

Which model sounds more like your country?

Vocabulary: match the words

Match each word with definition A–E. Work with a partner.

Word	Definition
Act (noun)	A. Traditions and culture passed from one generation to another.
Diversity	B. An agreed plan of action.
Heritage	C. To officially approve and introduce a new law.
Policy	D. A law made by a government.
To pass a law	E. A wide variety of people, cultures, or ideas.

CHECK THE MEANING

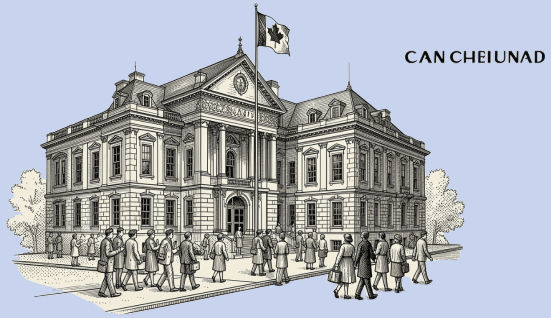
Vocabulary check

01	**Act:** a law made by a government.
02	**Diversity:** a wide variety of people, cultures, or ideas.
03	**Heritage:** traditions and culture passed from one generation to another.
04	**Policy:** an agreed plan of action.
05	**To pass a law:** to officially approve and introduce a new law.

Watch and listen for the key ideas

Watch “The Multiculturalism Act: How Canada Became a Nation of Diversity”. The teacher may pause after each section.

1. What year did Canada pass the Multiculturalism Act?
2. What is the main goal of the Act?
3. What does “mosaic, not melting pot” mean?
4. True or false: the Act forces immigrants to forget their original culture.



DISCUSS THE CONTEXT

Canada’s aim?

1988

Canada passed the Multiculturalism Act.

Why might a government support cultural diversity through policy?

- What could the Act help people do?
- What could it protect?
- What questions do you still have?

CITY COMMITTEE · TORONTO

City Committee: choose one project

You are a committee in Toronto. You have a **$50,000** budget. Choose only one project to promote the ideas of the Act.

A

Bilingual school

Free French-English classes for immigrant children.

B

Heritage festival

Communities share food, music, and clothing.

C

Translation services

A free app and hotline for doctors and police.

In your group: choose one project and prepare three reasons.

Defend your committee’s choice

Prepare a short recommendation for the city.

01	Our choice: _____
02	Reason 1: _____
03	Reason 2: _____
04	Reason 3: _____

Be ready to answer:

Who benefits?
What problem does it solve?

DISCUSSION

Dialogue of Cultures

Discuss in pairs or small groups, then share one idea with the class.

01 Does your country have a law like the Multiculturalism Act?

02 Is your country closer to a “melting pot” or a “mosaic”?

03 What are the benefits and challenges of living in a diverse society?

Use your own examples and give reasons.